

# A Letter to the Secretary of the Treasury

Mark Twain

Riverdale-on-the-Hudson, October 15, 1902

*This document consists of three versions:*

**uppercase:** *the salutation is in uppercase.*

**nobonds:** *the salutation is in uppercase, and the paragraph about government bonds omitted.*

**default:** *the salutation is in small caps, and the paragraph about government bonds included.*

*There are also updated versions of all three documents, which include the description of the Riverdale. The update is done in the nobonds version, and then propagated to the other versions of the document. This is shown on Figure 1.*

*This document' version is default. uppercase. nobonds.*

*This document is not updated.*

THE HON. THE SECRETARY OF THE TREASURY, WASHINGTON,  
D. C.: THE HON. THE SECRETARY OF THE TREASURY, WASHINGTON, D. C.:

Sir,—Prices for the customary kinds of winter fuel having reached an altitude which puts them out of the reach of literary persons in straitened circumstances, I desire to place with you the following order:

Forty-five tons best old dry government bonds, suitable for furnace, gold 7 per cents., 1864, preferred.

Twelve tons early greenbacks, range size, suitable for cooking.

Eight barrels seasoned 25 and 50 cent postal currency, vintage of 1866, eligible for kindlings.

Please deliver with all convenient despatch at my house in Riverdale at lowest rates for spot cash, and send bill to

Your obliged servant,

Mark Twain, Who will be very grateful, and will vote right.

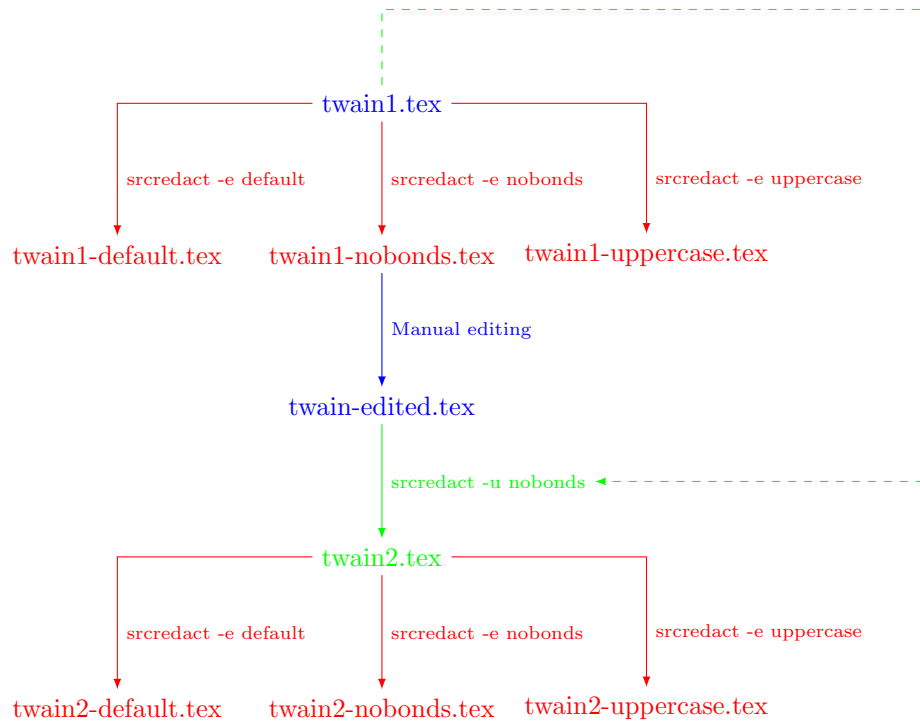


Figure 1: Document workflow. **Blue**—manual edits, **Red**—generated by srcredact in extract mode, **Green**—generated by srcredact in unextract mode.